

Annotation Guidelines

Project 003 – Named Entity Recognition (NER)

1. Project Overview

This document defines the annotation rules used throughout the Named Entity Recognition (NER) project. The objective is to ensure that all annotations are applied consistently across the dataset.

The annotation format follows a span-based approach:

[Entity]LABEL

Example:

[OpenAI]ORGANIZATION released [ChatGPT Enterprise]PRODUCT on [18 April 2026]DATE.

2. Entity Types

Label	Description
PERSON	Individual people
ORGANIZATION	Companies, institutions, agencies, universities, hospitals, airlines, government bodies, hotels, banks, courts, NGOs, and similar organizations
LOCATION	Countries, states, cities, airports, landmarks, museums, launch sites, and geographical places
PRODUCT	Commercial products, software, branded services, devices, media titles, applications, and platforms
EVENT	Conferences, summits, exhibitions, named annual events, and recognized celebrations
DATE	Calendar dates
TIME	Specific times
MONEY	Monetary values
EMAIL	Email addresses
PHONE	Telephone numbers

3. General Annotation Principles

➤ Longest Valid Entity Rule

Annotate the complete entity whenever possible.

Correct - [Massachusetts Institute of Technology]ORGANIZATION

Incorrect - [Massachusetts]LOCATION Institute of Technology

➤ Exact Entity Boundaries

Only annotate the entity itself. Exclude surrounding words that are not part of the official name.

Correct - The [World Bank]ORGANIZATION

Incorrect - [The World Bank]ORGANIZATION

➤ Possessive Forms

Do not include grammatical possessive endings inside the entity span.

Correct - [Microsoft]ORGANIZATION's website

Incorrect - [Microsoft's]ORGANIZATION website

➤ Generic Nouns

Generic nouns are not annotated.

Examples:

- mobile app
- website
- software
- phone
- laptop
- company
- hospital
- university

Unless they are part of an official entity name.

Example: [Barclays mobile app]PRODUCT

4. Entity-Specific Rules

➤ PERSON

Annotate names of individual people.

Examples:

[Emily Johnson]PERSON

[Ahmed Yusuf]PERSON

Titles such as Dr., Professor, and CEO are not included unless officially part of a name.

➤ ORGANIZATION

Annotate companies, institutions, government agencies, universities, hospitals, airlines, NGOs, hotels, banks, and courts.

Examples:

[OpenAI]ORGANIZATION

[University of Melbourne]ORGANIZATION

[UNICEF]ORGANIZATION

[Hilton Amsterdam Airport Schiphol]ORGANIZATION

➤ LOCATION

Annotate physical places.

Examples:

[Paris]LOCATION

[Abuja]LOCATION

[John F. Kennedy International Airport]LOCATION

[Eiffel Tower]LOCATION

[Vandenberg Space Force Base]LOCATION

➤ PRODUCT

Annotate commercial products and branded services.

Examples:

[ChatGPT Enterprise]PRODUCT

[Galaxy Tab S11 Ultra]PRODUCT

[Microsoft 365 Family]PRODUCT

[Amazon Pharmacy]PRODUCT

[Jurassic World Rebirth]PRODUCT

➤ **EVENT**

Annotate conferences, exhibitions, summits, named annual events, and recognised celebrations.

Examples:

[OpenAI DevDay 2026]EVENT

[CinemaCon 2026]EVENT

[Christmas 2026]EVENT

Do not annotate seasons.

Examples:

- Summer 2026
 - Winter 2026
 - Spring 2026
 - Autumn 2026
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➤ **DATE**

Annotate complete calendar dates.

Example: [18 April 2026]DATE

Do not annotate relative dates such as:

- today
 - tomorrow
 - yesterday
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➤ **TIME**

Annotate specific times.

Example: [11:30 AM]TIME

➤ **MONEY**

Annotate monetary values with their currency symbols where present.

Examples:

[\$599]MONEY

[€5,200]MONEY

➤ **EMAIL**

Annotate complete email addresses.

Example:

[support@company.com]EMAIL

➤ **PHONE**

Annotate complete telephone numbers.

Example: [+2348123456789]PHONE

5. Project-Specific Decisions

The following adjudication decisions were applied consistently throughout this dataset.

- Branded digital services are annotated as PRODUCT.
 - Hotels are annotated as ORGANIZATION under this schema.
 - Museums are annotated as LOCATION.
 - Airports are annotated as LOCATION.
 - Government ministries and agencies are annotated as ORGANIZATION.
 - Universities and hospitals are annotated as ORGANIZATION.
 - Media titles are annotated as PRODUCT because no separate media category exists.
 - Named religious or cultural celebrations (e.g., Christmas, Easter, New Year) are annotated as EVENT.
 - Seasons (e.g., Summer, Winter) are not annotated.
 - Official entity names beginning with "The" are included only when "The" is part of the registered name (e.g., The Ritz London).
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